

Conversational mechanisms

- Various mechanisms and 'rules' are followed when holding a conversation, e.g. mutual greetings

A: Hi there

B: Hi!

C: Hi

A: All right?

C: Good, how's it going?

A: Fine, how are you?

C: OK

B: So-so. How's life treating you?

Conversational rules

- Sacks et al. (1978) work on conversation analysis describe three basic rules:

Rule 1: the current speaker chooses the next speaker by asking an opinion, question, or request

Rule 2: another person decides to start speaking

Rule 3: the current speaker continues talking

Conversational rules

- Turn-taking used to coordinate conversation
 - A: Shall we meet at 8?
 - B: Um, can we meet a bit later?
 - A: Shall we meet at 8?
 - B: Wow, look at him?
 - A: Yes what a funny hairdo!
 - B: Um, can we meet a bit later?
- Back channelling to signal to continue and following
 - Uh-uh, umm, ahh

More conversational rules

- Farewell rituals
 - Bye then, see you, yer bye, see you later....
- Implicit and explicit cues
 - e.g. looking at watch, fidgeting with coat and bags
 - explicitly saying “Oh dear, must go, look at the time, I’ m late...”